

Cut



Classic-cut diamond | Seen side-on, all of the facets of this champagne-coloured diamond are visible, either directly or through the stone.



Fancy cut | This triangle-cut diamond is technically a fancy cut, in that it has a number of extra, non-standard faces added to what is otherwise a brilliant cut.



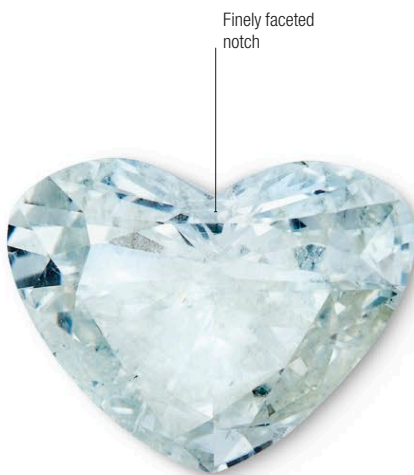
Blue emerald cut | The cutter of this diamond has chosen an emerald cut in order to enhance its blue tinge, but still retain its brilliance.



Mixed cut | This white diamond has had a number of extra faces added to the pavilion of a scissors-cut crown to increase the sparkle under the table.



Emerald cut | Even though the stone is small, the emerald cut of this gem has enhanced the steely sheen that this diamond possesses.



Fancy heart | Hearts are the most difficult shape to facet because of the faces in the top notch. The cutter of this stone has achieved the heart shape with great skill.



Standard brilliant | This diamond has been cut in the "standard" 58-facet brilliant cut, specifically developed to maximize the brilliance, or "fire", of a diamond.

Diamond enhancement

Bringing out the best

"Fancy" (coloured) diamonds demand high prices if the colours are definite and intense. Reds, violets, and blues bring the highest prices. They are not always what they seem. Today, a number of processes exist to change the colour of white diamonds, from irradiation to flooding them with gases that are absorbed and produce colour change. Other enhancements include laser drilling to remove inclusions and the application of sealants to fill cracks. Buyers should always purchase diamonds certified by a legitimate testing agency.



Marquise-cut blue Only a gemologist can tell if the colour of this stone is natural.